Two Columns of River Notes

Rivers carry sediment from the hills to the sea. Restoration projects begin by mapping where that sediment settles, because the shape of a channel follows the material it carries and the floods that move it.

Field teams walk each reach twice a year. They record bank height, the width of the active channel and the plants that hold the soil, so that later visits can measure change rather than guess at it.

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Monitoring continues for a decade after planting. Success is measured not by a single season but by whether the river can rebuild its own banks after the next great flood.

Continued Notes

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